

Lesson 45: “He That Overcometh Shall Inherit All Things” ([Revelation 21:7](#)) **Revelation 1-3; 12**

Purpose: To help us understand some of the blessings that will come to those who overcome the trials of mortality through their testimony of Jesus Christ.

- †1. Symbols and the book of Revelation †2. Bible Dictionary—Revelation of John
Why are symbols use for teaching and learning? †3. Symbols

1. John sees several symbols representing parts of the Church of Jesus Christ.

- A• [Rev. 1:1-3, 9-20](#) †4. The Isle of Patmos
B• **What is the theme of the book of Revelation?** †5. Theme of Revelation
C• [Rev. 1:11-12, 20](#) †6. Elder Bruce R. McConkie
D• [Rev. 1:13](#) **Where is the Savior in relation to the seven candlesticks?**
How is the Savior in the midst of his Church today?
E• [Rev. 1:16, 20](#) †7. Joseph Smith Translation
What did the sword represent?
F• See [D&C 6:2](#); [Hebrews 4:12](#); and [Helaman 3:29](#)
G• [Rev. 1:18](#) Christ held the “keys of hell and death.” (See also: [2 Nephi 9:10-13](#))

2. The Lord tells the seven branches in Asia about the blessings promised to those who overcome.

“Chapters 2 and 3 contain the words of the Lord to each of the seven branches of the Church in Asia. The Lord reviewed some of the strengths and weaknesses in each branch and warned the Saints to correct their weaknesses.” (*Lesson Manual*) **find the Lord’s Promises to Those Who Overcome.**

- A• [Rev. 2:1-7](#) To Ephesus “to eat of the tree of life” (See [1 Nephi 11:21-22](#))
B• [Rev. 2:8-11](#) To Smyrna “shall not be hurt of the second death” (See [Alma 12:16, 32](#); and [Hel. 14:18](#))
C• [Rev. 2:12-17](#) To Pergamos “to eat of the hidden manna” (See [John 6:35, 49-51](#))
D• [Rev. 2:18-29](#) To Thyatira “I give power over the nations ... with a rod of iron ... [and] the morning star” (See [1 Nephi 11:25](#))
E• [Rev. 3:1-6](#) To Sardis “clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life”
How does participation in temple ordinances prepare us to be “clothed in white” eternally?
What is the book of life? (See [D&C 128:7](#); [Exodus 32:33](#); [Alma 5:58](#); [Bible Dictionary—Book of Life](#))
What is the reward of those whose names are found in the book of life? (See [Rev. 21:10, 23-27](#))
F• [Rev. 3:7-13](#) To Philadelphia “I will write upon him the name of my God and the name of his city”
 “We become like God and become citizens of his eternal kingdom.” (*Lesson Manual*)
G• [Rev. 3:14-22](#) To Laodicea “will I grant to sit with me in my throne” (See [Romans 8:16-17](#))

3. John learns that the Saints overcome Satan through the Atonement of Jesus Christ and their testimonies.

- A• [Revelation 12](#) “John saw a symbolic vision of the War in Heaven and its continuation on earth.” (*LM*)
B• [Rev. 12:1-2, 5](#) “The woman described ... represents the Church of God. The child she brought forth represents the kingdom of God—the government that will exist on the earth during Jesus Christ’s millennial reign.” (See Joseph Smith Translation, Revelation 12:7; see also Joseph Fielding Smith, *Doctrines of Salvation*, comp. Bruce R. McConkie, 3 vols. [1954-56, 1:229.]) (*Lesson Manual*)
C• [Rev. 12:9](#) The “great dragon was ... called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world”
D• [Rev. 12:3-4, 7-9](#) **What happened to the dragon and his followers in the War in Heaven?**
E• [Rev. 12:17](#) **What did the dragon do after he was cast out?**
E• [Rev. 12:12](#) **What is the dragon doing now?**
F• [Rev. 12:11](#) **How will the Church and kingdom of God finally overcome Satan?**
How can the Atonement of Christ and our testimonies of it help us against Satan?
G• See †8. President Wilford Woodruff

([The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles: Course Manual \(Religion 211-212\)](#). Click on “[212 Contents](#)”)

Next Week: NT L46: “He Will Dwell with Them and They Shall Be His People” Revelation 5-6; 19-22 † •



†1. **Symbols and the book of Revelation:** “Symbols are used throughout the scriptures, but especially in the book of Revelation...

“The Apostle John, author of the book of Revelation, came out of a culture that used symbolism extensively in its language and literature. Readers today often have difficulty with the symbolism in John’s writings. If we interpret the images literally, the book of Revelation can seem strange and confusing. If we remember that many of the images are symbolic and represent people, things, or concepts with which we are already familiar, the book becomes easier to understand.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†2. **Bible Dictionary—Revelation of John:** Also known as the Apocalypse, a Greek word meaning revealed or uncovered. The message of Revelation is the same as that of all scripture: there will be an eventual triumph on this earth of God over the devil; a permanent victory of good over evil, of the saints over their persecutors, of the kingdom of God over the kingdoms of men and of Satan. This is the subject on which Amos, Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel, Daniel, Paul, Peter, and all the prophets have written. They spoke of a day of victory that would come, and that the end would be better (i.e., more glorious) than the beginning. The victory would be achieved through Jesus Christ.

Such is the theme of the Revelation. The details about the beasts, the wars, the angels, the men, etc., contribute to the development of this theme. By a little study, the theme can be perceived even if the details are not completely identified. It may be in this sense that the Prophet Joseph Smith said that Revelation was “one of the plainest books God ever caused to be written” (HC 5:342). However, the more fully the details are understood, the greater will be the appreciation of the theme. If we fail to catch a glimpse of the theme, we fail in our comprehension, no matter how many details we are able to understand. ([Bible Dictionary—Revelation of John](#))

†3. **Symbols:** “They can help the learner understand and remember by comparing unfamiliar ideas or things to those that are more familiar; they can have different levels of meaning; they can encourage the learner to think more deeply about what is being taught.” (*LM*)

†4. **The Isle of Patmos:** “A short distance off the coast of present-day Turkey, in the sparkling blue waters of the Aegean Sea, lies a tiny, rocky island called Patmos. In Roman times, its barren isolation made it ideal as a site for the banishment of political prisoners, ambitious enemies, or others considered undesirable by the imperial state. To it in the last years of the first century A.D. came the exiled apostle John, known also as the Beloved. And to that rocky island prison on a Sunday some nineteen hundred years ago came the glorified, exalted Christ.” (*Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles*, Click on “212 Contents” and seek No. 54 “The Revelation of Jesus Christ ... Unto His Servant John,” Intro.)

†5. **Theme of Revelation:** “The book of Revelation is written primarily in symbolic language. Its theme is that “there will be an eventual triumph on this earth of God over the devil; a permanent victory of good over evil, of the saints over their persecutors, of the kingdom of God over the kingdoms of men and of Satan. ... By a little study, the theme can be perceived even if the details are not completely identified” (Bible Dictionary, “Revelation of John,” 762).

“The three introductory chapters of the book record John’s testimony of the truthfulness of the revelation, John’s instructions from the Lord, and John’s counsel to the seven branches of the Church in Asia. Chapter 4 records John’s vision of heaven, and chapters 5 through 20 record his vision of the triumphant destiny of God’s kingdom. This vision shows the battles against Satan’s kingdom, the destruction of Satan’s kingdom, and the final scenes in the world’s history. After this is a vision of the new heavens and new earth—the world in its celestial state (Revelation 21:1–5). The book of Revelation concludes with the angel’s testimony and additional counsel from the Lord.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†6. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “Candlesticks carry light; they do not create it. Their function is to make it available, not to bring it into being. So by using seven candlesticks to portray the seven churches to whom John is now to give counsel, the Lord is showing that his congregations on earth are to carry his light to the world” (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 3 vols. [1966–73], 3:442).

†7. **Joseph Smith Translation:** “Throughout the Joseph Smith Translation of Revelation 1–3, the word angels is changed to servants, making it clear that the stars represent the leaders of the seven branches of the Church.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†8. **President Wilford Woodruff:** “There are two powers on the earth and in the midst of the inhabitants of the earth—the power of God and the power of the devil. ... When God has had a people on the earth, it matters not in what age, Lucifer, the son of the morning, and the millions of fallen spirits that were cast out of heaven, have warred against God, against Christ, against the work of God, and against the people of God. And they are not backward in doing it in our day and generation. Whenever the Lord set His hand to perform any work, those powers labored to overthrow it” (in *Deseret Evening News*, 17 Oct. 1896, 9; quoted by Gordon B. Hinckley, in “[The War We Are Winning](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986, 43).

Recommended Conference Talks:

Jeffrey R. Holland, “[We Are All Enlisted](#),” Oct. 2011 general conference.

Robert D. Hales, “[Waiting upon the Lord: Thy Will Be Done](#),” Oct. 2011 general conference.

Russell M. Nelson, “[Face the Future with Faith](#),” Apr. 2011 general conference.

Paul V. Johnson, “[More Than Conquerors through Him That Loved Us](#),” Apr. 2011 general conference.

Richard G. Scott, “[The Power of a Strong Testimony](#),” Oct. 2001 general conference.

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